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Willow / Klein closeout

Naming revision: September 7, 2026, under the Klein decision. The substantive September 6 closeout remains in force.

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Decision date: September 6, 2026

State: LOCKED owner-approved canon; expressly noted implementation detail remains non-authoritative

Scope: Klein origins, Gid Voss, Eli Hoberg, Sar-e-Sang, Willow site identity, and Klein historical identity

Authority

This dated closeout records owner decisions made September 6, 2026. Once accepted into main, it supersedes conflicting OPEN/PROVISIONAL statements in earlier lore within this exact scope. Earlier source bytes and released packages remain historical evidence and are not silently rewritten.

WIL-002 — Gid Voss's first instrumentation incident

State: LOCKED

Gid Voss's defining pre-Klein Sable Harbor incident occurs in **2018 at a coal preparation plant**. A mass-balance problem appears to show coal disappearing between mine feed, preparation, reject streams, and loadout. The initial working assumption is an integration or reconciliation defect.

Gid refuses to stop at the database boundary. The investigation establishes that the records are internally coherent but the physical assumptions behind them are not. Moisture and density assumptions are being applied inconsistently across measurement points, and a process stream treated administratively as ordinary reject is carrying recoverable coal. The apparent missing tonnage is therefore not theft, fraud, or a software arithmetic error. The represented process does not match the physical process closely enough to support the conclusion being drawn from it.

The incident establishes Gid's early reputation: when an integrated representation produces an impossible physical answer, test the world before patching the representation. It also gives the later eastern coal mandate a direct technical lineage rather than making coal an arbitrary regional expansion.

Gid Voss — pre-Sable Harbor background and personal texture

State: LOCKED narrative texture

Before Sable Harbor, Gid works as an unusually broad civilian industrial-systems specialist. Some assignments place him alongside government or government-adjacent technical teams examining industrial systems whose paperwork, instrumentation, physical configuration, or externally visible behavior do not reconcile cleanly. He is not an intelligence officer and the canon does not convert him into one. The experience does, however, make him comfortable with incomplete records, strange physical systems, and the possibility that a technically correct representation can still describe the wrong world.

Outside work, Gid restores and collects mechanical and industrial instruments, including **Curta calculators**. He also operates a small hot-air-balloon experience business on the side. It is a modest operation rather than a major commercial enterprise: a small number of balloons, sunrise flights, and a small crew. The business begins partly as a way to subsidize his own flying and persists because he genuinely likes flying, weather, and the quiet observational quality of ballooning.

Eli Hoberg

State: LOCKED; supersedes the OPEN surname placeholder

The Klein RF/communications engineer is **Ellis “Eli” Hoberg**.

Before Sable Harbor, Hoberg works around forestry communications: logging crews, wildland-fire crews, and other workers operating in dense timber and mountainous terrain. He becomes frustrated by organizations spending heavily on radio systems that perform poorly in the actual terrain where crews depend on them. His objection is not that the radios are universally bad; it is that vendors and buyers repeatedly treat the radio as the whole communications system while ignoring terrain, relay placement, propagation, redundancy, and field architecture.

Hoberg begins designing improvised relay/repeater networks and creative communications architectures that make existing equipment work more reliably in forests and mountain ranges. He eventually forms a small specialist company called **Quality Forest Communications**. Its practical reputation is making other people's radios work where ordinary deployments do not.

That background is the direct precursor to his Klein role in underground RF and communications. His experimental RF mapping rig becomes **Theseus**, followed by Theseus II and III as every component is eventually replaced.

WIL-010 — Sar-e-Sang incident detail

State: LOCKED event expansion; no criminal or espionage finding

Two Klein personnel travel to Central Asia in 2022 under a loosely authorized industrial-observation and research premise. Their work expands into an approximately three-week unsanctioned journey involving Sar-e-Sang and other mining areas in Badakhshan, Afghanistan.

The access chain is deliberately difficult to reconstruct afterward. A regional minerals contact introduces an intermediary whose institutional affiliations are unclear. The travelers are discouraged from using company branding in some settings, movement is increasingly arranged by people whose names and affiliations are not consistently supplied, and ordinary commercial travel controls break down. Cash is used for transport, access, lodging, guides, and local facilitation. Some receipts are incomplete, some counterparties cannot later be identified to Sable Harbor's satisfaction, and some costs appear to have been paid or subsidized by third parties without a clean explanation.

As the trip progresses, questions directed at the travelers move beyond ordinary mining curiosity. They are asked what Sable Harbor's systems can infer from conflicting records, whether Foundry can identify undeclared physical activity through paperwork discrepancies, and what the company can see across industrial supply chains. At least one traveler records the substance of those questions because they feel out of place in the stated context.

Communications become intermittent and the travelers experience a material period during which Sable Harbor cannot reliably account for their location or itinerary. This is not canonized as a kidnapping or detention. The problem is that the company cannot reconstruct the period with enough confidence to rule out more concerning explanations. After return, leadership also finds route changes, unexplained or poorly supported expense-chain activity, and contextual details that neither traveler can fully explain.

Sable Harbor does **not** conclude that its personnel committed espionage, knowingly financed a terrorist organization, acted as intelligence officers, or knowingly entered an unlawful arrangement. Nor does it conclude that a foreign intelligence or security service targeted the company. The enduring problem is epistemic: leadership cannot confidently establish who some intermediaries represented, why certain questions were asked, who subsidized parts of the movement, or whether the travelers were being informally assessed for reasons unrelated to the stated mining purpose.

The concern becomes serious enough that senior leadership and counsel discuss whether the facts warrant voluntary contact with the **FBI regarding a potential counterintelligence exposure**. That discussion is real and documented internally; it is not treated as melodrama or as proof that a counterintelligence event occurred. The historical record does not assert a criminal referral, investigation, or intelligence finding. The uncertainty itself is consequential.

The incident is therefore both governance failure and institutional near miss. It is a major reason Klein cannot continue in its existing form and directly informs Willow's later bright lines: no freelance diplomacy, no unsanctioned field access, no untraceable cash arrangements, no representations outside delegated authority, and no production deployment without an operating owner and qualification gate.

Klein legacy inside Willow

State: LOCKED

Klein ends as an operating concept when Willow is created. It does not survive as a current department, shadow business line, or formal subunit.

Its physical archaeology does survive. Old Klein labels, stickers, stencils, prototype names, equipment markings, and at least one historical sign remain visible around Willow where the original object is still in use or deliberately preserved. Retired prototypes and artifacts may be displayed in the yard collection known as **the Museum**. Long-tenured employees may refer informally to the original “Klein crew,” but the term conveys history, not current authority.

The Fort — Willow's Pittsburgh compound

State: LOCKED site concept; exact parcel/address remains implementation detail

Willow's Pittsburgh-area physical center is a roughly **10–20 acre** industrial compound informally and then routinely called **the Fort**. The Fort is a working industrial research site, not a landscaped corporate campus.

The site has three principal structures:

1. **The Big Shed** — Willow's main research building and laboratory. Most experimental work, instrumentation, prototyping, integration, bench work, and hands-on research occurs here. It is explicitly not the primary administrative building and not bulk storage.
2. **The Small Shed** — administrative offices plus a small attached lodging component, effectively a modest internal mini-hotel for temporary stays by visiting staff, collaborators, field personnel, or employees whose work requires them to remain at the Fort for short periods. It is not permanent employee housing.
3. **The White Shed** — controlled intake, secure storage, utility, mechanical, staging, and quarantine space for unusual equipment, samples, field gear, or material that should not move directly onto the Big Shed research floor.

The remaining grounds are intentionally spare: controlled perimeter and gate, gravel circulation, hardstand, outdoor staging, utility/service areas, and practical non-sensitive storage. The working yards and accumulated outdoor collection are collectively known as **the Museum**. The name is affectionate and literal enough to persist: obsolete rigs, retired prototypes, industrial fragments, and odd pieces of equipment can remain because they preserve useful physical history, not because Willow is operating a public museum.

The Fort's naming follows Willow culture: useful, slightly irreverent labels become durable because everyone knows what they mean.

Klein visual identity

State: LOCKED name and owner-selected design, September 7, 2026

Klein's historical identity uses the selected petrol-blue and graphite mechanical K mark, the **KLEIN** wordmark, and **COAL & INDUSTRIAL SOLUTIONS** descriptor. The controlling approved PNG is `assets/brand/logos/klein__primary-horizontal.png`, with provenance in `assets/brand/klein_visual_manifest.json`. Willow retains its separate identity.

The September 7 name and identity decision replaces the earlier name and visual selection throughout the story. It creates no in-universe intermediate rename. Earlier artwork and prior design alternatives are superseded editorial history; the old tagline and coal/stone/orange mark do not control Klein.

Closeout boundary

This closeout resolves the prior OPEN/PROVISIONAL state of Gid's first incident, Eli's surname/background, WIL-010's substantive incident details, Klein's historical carryover, and Willow's Fort/site concept. It does not silently settle unrelated Willow/Atlas personnel details, exact statutory property records, exact parcel/address, or matters outside this scope.

Quality Forest Communications visual identity — September 7

QFC-VIS-001 locks the owner-selected tree/yellow-Q logo with its contained AN/PRC-117G, 2055 SATCOM antenna and script company name. It supplies the historical company artwork without changing Hoberg's history or the company relationships in this closeout.